

A matter of choice

Dear Karan,

I have been a reader of your magazine from its first issue onwards. In your editorial in the September 2001 issue, you commend VSNL's step of denying subscribers' basic rights of freedom to choose which e-mail identity they use while sending mail. While I do not like spam and am at the receiving end of a lot of junk mail myself, I still do not feel anyone has the right to take away from me my freedom to choose my e-mail address.

I run a small company with its own Web site and have configured my e-mail client to display my Web site e-mail address. I use multiple ISPs and if they were to start this practice as you have recommended in your editorial, I would be stuck. Having to use the reply addresses of the ISP which lets me connect on a particular day doesn't make sense because it would confuse my clients. I don't see why anyone should take away the right to use the e-mail address of my choice from a paying customer like me.

I am surprised that you are thinking so conservatively and are forgetting that Internet is there to promote freedom and not stifle it.

ANAND PRAKASH

Via e-mail

Goof Ups

■ Lokesh Bhamra points out that the images and descriptions of the Fuji Instax and the Sony DCR-PC9 Mini DV recorder were exchanged.

■ In the Monitor comparison test published in the September issue, the Scoreboard on page 114 lists the incorrect e-mail contact for Samsung Electronics India. The correct e-mail address is marketing@samsungindia.com

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

digit

Dear Anand,

I can understand your point about how this move from VSNL is going to affect the way you conduct your business. I also agree that you need to have the right to choose your own e-mail address.

However, I think that it is necessary to understand that while you, as a responsible individual, might be taking steps to ensure that you direct your messages to people willing to receive them, a majority of marketers today have no such compunctions. Which raises the question of whether individuals have the right or freedom to choose what kind of messages they receive.

Another point to be considered is whether VSNL will offer you a service that will allow you to send mail via their server using your Web site address, at a price. While

this might seem unfair at this point of time, this is something that Internet service users have to reconcile themselves to all over the world, mostly because of the inability of ISPs to handle the amount of spam generated.

You mention that I am being conservative when I say that all ISPs should consider such measures. I beg to differ. Sit back for a minute and think of the Internet as a shared resource that is depleted in a significant manner by spam. You will see that there are really only two alternatives open to us. Either we let the existing system remain because change is too difficult, or take the other more difficult course due to the benefits it could bring us in the long run.

Short Bytes

C__P__R

We received a lot of responses to Udit Madan's letter in the September issue of Short Bytes requesting the full form for the word COMPUTER.

While we had some interesting suggestions like 'Condemnable Operator of Machine Peripherals Using Tardy Electronic Resources', many of you came up with this one: 'Commonly Operated Machine Purposely Used for Training Education & Research'.

Via e-mail

If you have suggestions on how to make Digit better, come participate in the reader survey at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/survey/betterdigit>

Monitor it right

Dear Karan,

The monitor comparison test carried in the September issue of Digit had some errors in it. We find that not enough care has been taken while compiling the data for the tables in the magazine.

In the comparison table there are inconsistencies in the dot-pitch listed for different products. In some cases you have listed the horizontal dot-pitch and in others the diagonal dot-pitch, which is completely misleading for your readers. This is a gimmick that is used by manufacturers to cause confusion in readers minds about the performance of their products.

We would like to point out that the errors are present in the Scoreboard on page 114 and list the incorrect dot-pitch for the Samsung 15-inch monitor. The actual diagonal dot-pitch should read as 0.28. This mistake has been repeated on page 115.

It is disheartening to find such errors in a leading IT magazine like Digit.

UMANG

Roop Electronics & Allied Industries

digit

Dear Umang,

The error you refer to, which was due to an oversight at our end, is regretted.

As you have mentioned, the dot-pitch should be measured diagonally and this has been kept in mind by us while evaluating the monitors.

The inconsistencies were a result of human error, in spite of our best efforts. We shall ensure that greater care is taken in the future.

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